

Richardson Police Department

PUBLIC SAFETY CADETS

Competition Training Guide

Preparing Cadets for Excellence in Public Safety Competitions

200 N. Greenville Ave, Richardson, TX 75081 | (972) 744-4801

rpdcadets.com

DISCLAIMER: This training guide was developed by the Richardson Police Department Public Safety Cadets to provide cadets with standardized competition training principles. The content draws upon established law enforcement training doctrine, current police tactics, and nationally recognized competition standards. This guide is not all-inclusive but suggests specific techniques for maximum scoring potential at Public Safety Cadets competitions. All training should be conducted under proper supervision consistent with PSC's mission to develop character, physical fitness, and respect for the rule of law.

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TEAM SCENARIO TRAINING GUIDE

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Chapter 1

ACTIVE THREAT RESPONSE

INTRODUCTION:

This scenario provides cadets with foundational principles for responding to active threat incidents. The term 'active threat' replaces the older 'active shooter' terminology to encompass any individual actively causing death or serious bodily injury using any weapon or method. The primary objective is to stop the killing, stop the dying. This chapter covers contact team formations, tactical movement, communication, and casualty care priorities consistent with current law enforcement doctrine.

TYPICAL SCENARIO:

The team acts as first-responding patrol officers dispatched to reports of an active threat at a school, workplace, or public venue. Objectives include: assembling and moving as a contact team, conducting primary and secondary searches, engaging or detaining the threat, following use-of-force principles, coordinating with dispatch and rescue teams, and identifying injured persons for medical response. Maximum score: 100 points.

KEY PRINCIPLES:

Modern active threat response is built on the principle that the first arriving officers must take immediate action. Waiting for specialized units (SWAT) is no longer the standard when lives are actively being lost. The contact team's mission is to locate and neutralize the threat as rapidly as possible. This is a time-critical scenario — every second counts.

FORMATION — THE DIAMOND:

The diamond formation is the standard four-person contact team configuration. Position A (Point/Lead) moves at the front, responsible for forward threat identification and navigation. Positions B and C (Flanks) cover left and right respectively, protecting the team's sides. Position D (Rear Guard) covers the team from behind. The point sets pace and direction; flanks maintain 45-degree offset angles; the rear guard moves backward or sideways to maintain 360-degree coverage.

SCORING TIP: Points are awarded for maintaining proper formation throughout movement. Judges look for discipline — cadets who break formation, bunch up, or leave gaps between positions will lose points. Practice smooth transitions around corners and through doorways.

COMMUNICATION AND ENTRY:

Before entry, the team leader radios dispatch that a contact team has been assembled and states which entry point will be used. Request additional resources: K-9, SWAT/SRT, helicopter, armored vehicle, mobile command post, and EMS staging. While these units may not be available in competition, requesting them earns points. Upon entry, use dynamic movement while maintaining formation. Update dispatch with any new intelligence — number of shots heard, suspect description, victim locations.

WEAPON SAFETY:

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Cadets will typically use airsoft training pistols with full-face protection. Treat all training weapons as real firearms at all times. Key safety rules: trigger finger indexed (off trigger) unless engaging a threat, muzzle awareness at all times (never 'laser' a teammate), maintain facemask throughout the scenario. ANY safety violation — facemask removal, negligent discharge, muzzling a teammate — results in automatic disqualification.

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: *Lasering teammates, removing facemask, stopping in the fatal funnel of doorways, failing to communicate with dispatch, splitting the team without cause, friendly fire, excessive or unjustified use of force.*

COVER AND MOVEMENT:

Avoid the 'fatal funnel' — never stop in doorways. Use the center of hallways rather than hugging walls (bullets ricochet along wall surfaces). Clear rooms systematically using button-hook or cross-entry techniques. Each room should be declared 'clear' verbally before the team advances.

INJURED PERSONS:

The contact team does NOT stop to render aid. Their mission is to find and stop the threat. Relay the location of all injured persons to dispatch so a dedicated rescue team can respond. Gather intelligence from conscious wounded: number of shooters, description, weapons, direction of travel.

SUSPECT CONTACT:

When the threat is located, cadets must be prepared to make shoot/don't-shoot decisions based on use-of-force principles. If the suspect surrenders, transition to arrest protocols: verbal commands, controlled approach, handcuffing, search, and securing weapons as evidence. If the suspect is actively threatening lives, engagement is justified. Cadets must articulate their reasoning for all actions.

HOSTAGE CONSIDERATIONS:

If the suspect takes hostages, the contact team must rapidly distinguish hostage from threat. Do not fire unless a clear shot exists that does not endanger the hostage. Attempt verbal commands to the suspect to surrender and to the hostage to get down.

TEAMWORK:

Judges evaluate whether all four team members contribute meaningfully. Points are deducted for a single cadet doing everything while others stand idle. Demonstrate coordinated movement, verbal and hand-signal communication, and mutual support.

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Capital Murder (TX Penal Code §19.03)
- Murder (TX PC §19.02)
- Manslaughter (TX PC §19.04)
- Criminally Negligent Homicide (TX PC §19.05)
- Aggravated Kidnapping (TX PC §20.04)
- Aggravated Assault (TX PC §22.02)

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Chapter 2

ARREST/SEARCH WARRANTS

INTRODUCTION:

This scenario trains cadets in the planning, coordination, and execution of arrest and search warrants. Proper warrant service requires intelligence gathering, tactical entry, occupant control, systematic searching, evidence documentation, and adherence to constitutional requirements. This is one of the most comprehensive competition scenarios, testing nearly every fundamental police skill.

TYPICAL SCENARIO:

The team receives intelligence information and a legal search warrant for specific contraband (narcotics, weapons, or stolen property) at a designated premise. The team must plan and execute the warrant service, secure all occupants, conduct a thorough search, collect and log evidence, and properly charge suspects. Maximum score: 100 points. Time limit: 45 minutes.

ORGANIZATION:

Four cadets, one designated team leader prior to the scenario. The team leader delegates responsibilities: entry positions, occupant control, evidence collection, and radio communication. A pre-entry briefing demonstrates planning competence to judges.

BRIEFING — CRITICAL INTELLIGENCE:

The team leader must verify with the judge that the warrant is valid (signed by a judge/magistrate), confirm the address, and gather intelligence on the target location. Ask about: number of occupants, animals on premises, vehicle descriptions, layout of residence, door direction/facing, firearms known, prior call history, criminal history of wanted persons. Each question asked may earn points.

SCORING TIP: Judges award points for thorough pre-entry briefing questions. Prepare a mental checklist of at least 8-10 intelligence questions. Even if the judge says 'unknown,' you earn credit for asking.

KNOCK AND ANNOUNCE:

Unless the warrant specifies otherwise, all warrants default to knock-and-announce. Knock firmly at least three times, announce loudly: 'POLICE — SEARCH WARRANT' or 'RICHARDSON POLICE — SEARCH WARRANT.' Wait a reasonable time for response before entry. For competition, doors are never breached physically.

ARRIVAL AND APPROACH:

Radio dispatch upon arrival. Request secure radio channel, K-9 unit, medics, and hazmat (if drug manufacturing is suspected) on standby. Approach tactically — avoid being visible through windows/doors. Move with purpose but maintain noise discipline until announcement.

ENTRY AND ROOM CLEARING:

Enter dynamically. Do not stop in doorways (fatal funnel). All team members announce 'POLICE — SEARCH WARRANT' while clearing rooms. Use loud, clear verbal commands: 'GET ON THE GROUND,' 'SHOW ME YOUR

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HANDS,' 'DON'T MOVE.' Trigger fingers indexed at all times during entry. Control all occupants using appropriate force — excessive force (actor yelling 'PAIN') results in point deductions. Handcuff all subjects using prone method for maximum control, double-lock all cuffs.

OCCUPANT CONTROL:

Never leave a cadet alone with a suspect. Move all occupants to a central location for better control. After primary sweep, conduct secondary sweep for hidden suspects. After secondary sweep is clear, holster weapons unless the situation re-escalates. Station one cadet at the entry point to prevent unauthorized access or escape.

FRISK AND SEARCH:

Terry frisk all detained persons for weapons. Be thorough — judges may ask each cadet to articulate their legal justification. If weapons, drugs, or contraband are found during the frisk, charge the correct person with the correct offense for the specific item found.

IDENTITY AND ARREST:

Identify all occupants through dispatch (NCIC/TCIC) using full name, DOB, sex, race, and DL number. Once the warrant subject is identified, advise: 'YOU ARE UNDER ARREST for [specific warrant charge].' If a subject refuses to identify themselves, match physical description from the warrant. Read Miranda warnings to any suspect being questioned about the offense. Confirm understanding, document that the interview is being recorded (simulated), and note all statements.

METH LAB/HAZMAT:

If the premises show signs of active drug manufacturing: DO NOT TOUCH ANYTHING. Immediately request hazmat, evacuate all persons, and hold the scene until hazmat clearance.

EVIDENCE COLLECTION:

Assign one cadet as evidence officer with legible handwriting. Photograph all evidence before collection — distance shots, mid-range, and close-up with scale reference. Check all firearms through NCIC/TCIC stolen gun database (manufacturer, model, serial, caliber). Simulate unloading firearms physically. Search thoroughly — check under tables, inside trash cans, hidden compartments. Look for: cash, modified firearms, ledgers, computers, storage devices, receipts, bank statements, drug paraphernalia. Complete the evidence transmittal form. Leave a copy of the warrant and inventory log at the premises.

TRANSPORT:

Notify dispatch of transport, listing each suspect and their specific charges.

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: *Unjustified weapon discharge, excessive force (actor says 'PAIN'), explorer killed by suspect or friendly fire, failure to double-lock handcuffs, failure to Miranda, incorrect charges for evidence found.*

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Unlawful Possession of Firearm (TX PC §46.04)
- Prohibited Weapons (TX PC §46.05)
- Manufacture/Delivery of Controlled Substance PG1 (TX HSC §481.112)
- Possession of Controlled Substance PG1-4 (TX HSC §481.115-118)
- Possession of Marijuana (TX HSC §481.121)
- Possession/Delivery of Drug Paraphernalia (TX HSC §481.125)

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Chapter 3

BOMB THREAT RESPONSE

INTRODUCTION:

Bomb threat scenarios test cadets' ability to conduct threat assessments, investigate explosive/chemical/biological/nuclear device threats, interview complainants, and coordinate with specialized units. Safety awareness is paramount — electronic devices can trigger remotely detonated devices.

TYPICAL SCENARIO:

The team arrives at a location where a bomb threat has been received. Objectives include: conducting a threat assessment, interviewing the call recipient, searching for suspicious devices, apprehending suspects, and coordinating with EOD (Bomb Squad). Maximum score: 100 points. Time limit: 45 minutes.

SAFETY — ELECTRONIC DEVICE AWARENESS:

Upon arrival within 100 yards of the premise, turn OFF all electronic devices: police radios, cell phones, laptops, anything transmitting Wi-Fi/Bluetooth/radio signals. These can trigger remotely detonated devices. IEDs can also use timers, pressure switches, mercury switches, trip wires, photo-sensor beams, heat sensors, or remote control activation.

SCORING TIP: Judges specifically watch for whether cadets power down electronic devices. This is often a missed point opportunity. Make it obvious — announce to your team: 'All electronics off, we are within the safety perimeter.'

APPROACH AND ENTRY:

Park a minimum of 100 yards away. Approach cautiously — devices may be concealed in trash receptacles, landscaping, or building exteriors. Observe occupant behavior before entry. Look for anything out of place or suspicious.

INTERVIEW THE CALL TAKER:

Conduct a thorough interview of whoever received the threat. Critical questions include: What did the caller's voice sound like (calm, excited, accent, speech impediment)? Were background sounds audible (street noise, machinery, music)? Was threatening language used? Estimated age, sex, and race/ethnicity of caller? Exact time and duration of the call? Phone number receiving the call? Exact wording of the threat?

SUSPECT HANDLING:

If a suspect is located, be aware they may have explosives on their person or be using a remote detonation device. Secure their hands immediately — prevent access to any electronic devices until the situation is resolved.

DEVICE LOCATED:

If a suspicious device is found: DO NOT TOUCH IT. Establish a safe perimeter (minimum 300 feet for small packages, more for larger devices). Request EOD/Bomb Squad immediately. Evacuate all persons upwind and uphill from the device. Document and photograph the device from a safe distance only after EOD clearance.

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COMMON DEDUCTIONS: *Failing to turn off electronics, touching a suspicious device, inadequate perimeter, poor interview of call taker, unjustified force.*

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Terroristic Threat (TX PC §22.07)
- Arson (TX PC §28.02)
- False Alarm or Report (TX PC §42.06)
- Hoax Bombs (TX PC §46.08)
- Components or Explosives (TX PC §46.09)

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Chapter 4 BURGLARY IN-PROGRESS

(Building Searches)

INTRODUCTION:

This scenario trains cadets in tactical building search procedures in response to alarm calls, open-door discoveries, or active burglary reports. Emphasis is on systematic room clearing, suspect apprehension, evidence collection, and officer safety.

TYPICAL SCENARIO:

Team responds to an alarm call, open door, or burglary in-progress. Objectives: safely search the location using tactical methods, locate and apprehend suspects, collect evidence, and conduct a thorough investigation. Maximum: 100 points. Time limit: 45 minutes.

KEY TACTICS:

Request K-9 (points for asking). Announce 'POLICE' before entry. Enter quietly but maintain formation. Use leap-frog clearing method. 'Cutting the pie' or 'quick-peek' at corners — points deducted for rounding corners blindly. Minimize verbal communication during active search; use pre-arranged hand signals. Flashlight discipline: short momentary bursts only, never backlight partners. Use room lights when available.

SCORING TIP: Judges look for proper corner techniques. Practice 'slicing the pie' at every corner and doorway. This single skill differentiates top teams.

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: Turning corners without clearing, backlighting teammates, missing hidden suspects, splitting team without radio communication, firearm safety violations.

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Burglary (TX PC §30.02)
- Criminal Trespass (TX PC §30.05)
- Evading Arrest (TX PC §38.04)

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Chapter 5 CRIME PREVENTION

INTRODUCTION:

Crime prevention scenarios test cadets' ability to present programs like Neighborhood Watch, conduct Crime Prevention Through Environmental Design (CPTED) surveys, and demonstrate knowledge through written exams.

TYPICAL SCENARIOS:

Cadets may present a Neighborhood Watch pitch to a civic group (10-15 minutes, all members participate equally), conduct a CPTED assessment of a business/home with security recommendations, or take a 50-question exam on crime prevention principles. Topics include: levels of security, landscaping concerns, door/window barriers, lock systems, alarm systems, lighting (interior/exterior), risk management, Operation Identification, Neighborhood Watch, and H.E.A.T. program. Maximum: 100 points.

SCORING TIP: For presentations, ensure *EVERY* team member speaks for roughly equal time. Judges track individual participation. Rehearse transitions between speakers.

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: Unequal participation, providing incorrect information about programs, poor exam scores.

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Chapter 6

CRIME SCENE INVESTIGATION

INTRODUCTION:

CSI scenarios evaluate cadets' ability to secure a crime scene, locate and document evidence, collect and log evidence with proper chain of custody, lift fingerprints, photograph the scene, and take measurements for diagramming.

KEY PROCEDURES:

Upon arrival, conduct a safety sweep first. Secure the scene and start an entry/exit log at the door. If no search warrant was provided, request one before processing. Wear gloves at all times when handling evidence. Exercise extreme care: do not step in blood, touch surfaces that need fingerprinting, or handle firearms bare-handed. Photograph evidence using the three-shot method: distance/context, mid-range, and close-up with scale. Collect evidence using proper containers (paper bags for biological, plastic for non-biological), tag/mark each item, and complete an evidence transmittal log with report number.

SCORING TIP: *Crime scene kits will be provided — don't bring your own. Focus on systematic, thorough searching and meticulous documentation. Legible evidence logs earn major points.*

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: *Contaminating evidence, missing key evidence items, poor photography technique, failure to obtain search warrant, inadequate chain of custody documentation.*

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Murder (TX PC §19.02)
- Aggravated Assault (TX PC §22.02)
- Aggravated Robbery (TX PC §29.03)

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Chapter 7 CRISIS NEGOTIATION

(Hostage Negotiation)

INTRODUCTION:

Crisis negotiation scenarios evaluate cadets' ability to resolve a critical incident through communication, teamwork, and strategic planning. The goal is always peaceful resolution.

TEAM ROLES:

Team Leader: oversees strategy, maintains chronological log of demands/concessions/weapons/hostages. Primary Negotiator: establishes rapport and communicates directly with the subject. Secondary Negotiator: passes written notes and suggestions to primary (never interrupts verbally). Support: gathers intel from outside sources (witnesses, family), relays to team and tactical commanders.

NEGOTIATION PRINCIPLES:

Introduce yourself and give callback instructions. Ask for surrender at the start (points for asking, even though the suspect won't comply in competition). Use the subject's name frequently. Ask open-ended questions — let them vent. Practice active listening. Use a calm, slower voice to de-escalate. Never lie, bluff, or mislead in ways that damage credibility. Deflect deadlines — 'talk through' them rather than accepting or setting them. Trade — food for hostages, utilities for children/elderly. Never trade person-for-person, provide weapons, or promise prisoner release. All deals require 'supervisor approval' (you cannot approve). Spend 50% of time 'offline' in team brainstorming sessions. Decisions are team decisions, not solo.

SCORING TIP: *The #1 scoring factor is demonstrating ACTIVE LISTENING. Repeat back what the subject says in your own words. Show empathy. Judges award points for rapport-building, not just information gathering.*

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: *Arguing with/provoking the suspect, causing a hostage death through miscommunication, making promises you can't keep, primary negotiator making unilateral decisions.*

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Chapter 8

DOMESTIC CRISIS INTERVENTION

(Family Violence)

INTRODUCTION:

Domestic violence calls are among the most dangerous and complex situations officers face. This scenario tests cadets' ability to investigate family violence, separate and interview parties, make proper arrests, complete required documentation, and provide victim resources.

KEY DEFINITIONS:

Family Violence (TX Family Code §71.004): An act by a family/household member intended to result in physical harm, bodily injury, assault, or sexual assault, or a threat placing another in fear of imminent harm. Includes dating violence and child abuse. **Household**: Persons living together, regardless of relation. **Family**: Related by blood or marriage, former spouses, parents of same child, foster relationships.

CRITICAL PROCEDURES:

Separate all parties before interviews to prevent story coordination. Interview victim and suspect independently. Photograph all visible injuries (distance, mid-range, close-up with scale). Request medical response for injured parties. Provide victim with crime victim information pamphlet and report number. Complete the Texas DPS Family Violence Report Form if required. Check all parties through NCIC/TCIC. A protective sweep of the premises is justified for officer safety.

SCORING TIP: *Separating parties IMMEDIATELY is a major scoring factor. Judges watch for this as one of the first actions. Also, providing the victim pamphlet/card before leaving is often forgotten but always scored.*

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Assault — Family Violence (TX PC §22.01)
- Aggravated Assault — FV (TX PC §22.02)
- Injury to Child/Elderly/Disabled (TX PC §22.04)

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Chapter 9

GANG ACTIVITY

INTRODUCTION:

Gang activity scenarios test cadets' ability to safely approach, contact, and investigate individuals associated with criminal gang activity. Emphasis is on proper approach, contact/cover principles, verbal de-escalation skills, observation, and arrest techniques.

KEY DEFINITION:

Criminal Street Gang (TX PC §71.01): Three or more persons with common identifying signs/symbols or identifiable leadership who continuously or regularly associate in criminal activities. **Gang-Free Zones**: Within 1,000 feet of schools, youth centers, playgrounds; within 300 feet of malls, theaters, swimming pools, arcades, or on school buses — enhanced penalties apply.

TACTICAL APPROACH:

Use cover and concealment. Separate different gang factions from each other. Be alert for concealed weapons — terry frisk if reasonable belief exists. Document all gang identifiers: tattoos, clothing colors, hand signs, graffiti. Run all subjects through NCIC/TCIC. Interview witnesses/victims separately.

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: *Crossfire situations, failing to separate rival gang members, charging suspects with wrong offenses, poor officer safety awareness.*

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Engaging in Organized Criminal Activity (TX PC §71.02)
- Deadly Conduct (TX PC §22.05)
- Graffiti (TX PC §28.08)

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Chapter 10 INTOXICATED DRIVER

INTRODUCTION:

The intoxicated driver scenario evaluates cadets' ability to conduct a proper traffic stop, administer Standardized Field Sobriety Tests (SFSTs) per NHTSA standards, make arrest decisions, and complete required DWI paperwork.

SFST — HGN (Horizontal Gaze Nystagmus):

6 total clues (3 per eye). 4+ clues indicates BAC above .08. Procedure: feet together/hands at sides, follow stimulus with eyes only (no head movement), hold stimulus 12-15 inches from face above eye level. Test sequence: Equal Tracking/Pupil Size → Lack of Smooth Pursuit (2 sec out, 2 sec back) → Distinct & Sustained Nystagmus at Maximum Deviation (hold 4+ seconds) → Onset Prior to 45° (4 seconds to reach 45°) → Vertical Nystagmus (hold 4 seconds). Judge provides HGN clue count.

SFST — WALK AND TURN:

8 total clues, 2+ indicates above .08. Instructional stance: left foot on line, right foot heel-to-toe, arms at sides. Demonstrate 9 heel-to-toe steps, pivot turn with small steps, 9 steps back. Clues: can't balance during instructions, starts too soon, stops walking, misses heel-to-toe, steps off line, uses arms for balance, improper turn, wrong number of steps.

SFST — ONE LEG STAND:

4 total clues, 2+ indicates above .08. Stand on one foot approximately 6 inches off ground, toe pointed, count 'one-thousand-one, one-thousand-two...' for approximately 30 seconds. Clues: sways, uses arms for balance, hops, puts foot down.

SCORING TIP: Demonstrate each SFST to the subject before having them perform it. Ask about medical conditions, medications, and last food intake before testing. These are NHTSA requirements and judges score them.

DWI PAPERWORK:

Complete Texas DIC-23 (Peace Officer's Sworn Report), DIC-24 (Statutory Warning), and DIC-25 (Notice of Suspension) and read applicable portions to the driver before transport.

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- DWI (TX PC §49.04)
- DWI with Child Passenger (TX PC §49.045)
- Public Intoxication (TX PC §49.02)
- Open Container (TX PC §49.031)

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Chapter 11 OFFICER DOWN/RESCUE

(Emergency First Aid)

INTRODUCTION:

This scenario combines tactical rescue under fire with emergency medical skills. Cadets must locate and extract injured persons while managing threats, then provide appropriate first aid including CPR, bleeding control, fracture management, and shock treatment.

TACTICAL RESCUE:

Assemble as a rescue team in diamond formation. Request EMS/ambulances. Enter dynamically and locate injured persons. Provide cover while the designated medic assesses patients.

PATIENT ASSESSMENT — ABCs:

Airway: Responsive patient — check for clear speech, gurgling. Unresponsive — head-tilt/chin-lift (or jaw-thrust if trauma suspected). Clear obstructions. **Breathing:** Look, listen, feel. Adequate = chest rise, ease of breathing, appropriate rate. If absent/inadequate, ventilate immediately. **Circulation:** Responsive adult — radial pulse. Unresponsive adult — carotid pulse. Infant — brachial pulse. No pulse = begin CPR.

CPR — ADULT:

30 compressions : 2 breaths. Compression rate: 100-120/min. Depth: 2-2.4 inches (5-6 cm). Allow full chest recoil. Locate compression site: center of chest between nipples, heel of hand on sternum. Lock elbows, shoulders directly over hands, compress straight down.

BLEEDING CONTROL:

Direct pressure with gloved hand and gauze. Elevate above heart (if no fracture suspected). If bleeding continues, apply additional gauze (never remove initial gauze). Use pressure points (brachial for arms, femoral for legs). Apply tourniquet for life-threatening extremity hemorrhage — current best practice is 'high and tight' application.

SHOCK:

Signs: restlessness/irritability (first sign), pale/cool/clammy skin, nausea, rapid pulse, rapid breathing, excessive thirst, dilated pupils. Treatment: monitor ABCs, maintain body temperature, elevate legs 8-12 inches (unless head/chest/back injury). Treat for shock proactively — don't wait for visible signs.

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: *Wrong treatment, causing additional harm to patients, getting shot during rescue, failing to request EMS, inadequate ABCs assessment.*

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Chapter 12

ROBBERY IN-PROGRESS

INTRODUCTION:

Robbery in-progress scenarios test cadets' ability to respond rapidly to violent crimes, use tactical approach and entry techniques, control suspects, investigate the scene, and protect victims.

KEY DEFINITIONS:

Robbery (TX PC §29.02): Theft + intentionally/knowingly/recklessly causing bodily injury or threatening imminent bodily injury/death. Felony 2nd degree. **Aggravated Robbery** (TX PC §29.03): Robbery + serious bodily injury, use of deadly weapon, or victim is 65+ or disabled. Felony 1st degree.

RESPONSE:

Approach using cover and concealment. Request K-9 for fleeing suspects. Enter tactically — 'POLICE' announcement. Clear systematically. Control all persons. Separate suspects from victims. Full investigation with Miranda, evidence collection, and photography.

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Robbery (TX PC §29.02)
- Aggravated Robbery (TX PC §29.03)
- Assault (TX PC §22.01)
- Evading Arrest (TX PC §38.04)

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Chapter 13

MENTAL HEALTH CRISIS RESPONSE

(Suicidal/Mentally Unstable Persons)

INTRODUCTION:

This scenario emphasizes verbal de-escalation, crisis intervention, and peaceful resolution. NO TASERS, PEPPER SPRAY, OR LESS-LETHAL DEVICES may be deployed. The evaluation centers on communication skills.

KEY LEGAL FRAMEWORK:

Apprehension Without Warrant (TX Health Code §573.001): A peace officer may take a person into custody without a warrant if they have reason to believe the person is mentally ill AND there is a substantial risk of serious harm to themselves or others unless immediately restrained. Transport to the nearest appropriate inpatient mental health facility — a jail may NOT be used except in extreme emergency.

DE-ESCALATION TECHNIQUES:

Maintain a calm, professional, courteous tone throughout. Approach using cover/concealment. Establish verbal contact from a safe distance. Use the person's name. Ask open-ended questions. Listen actively — reflect their feelings back. Never rush or issue ultimatums. If the person is armed, they must voluntarily drop weapons before any physical restraint. The goal is a peaceful resolution.

SCORING TIP: The ENTIRE score for this scenario is based on communication quality. Practice active listening, empathy statements ('I can see this is really difficult for you'), and patient problem-solving. Judges want to see genuine rapport-building, not scripted responses.

TRANSPORT:

Complete the 'Peace Officer's Application for Emergency Detention' form if transporting to a mental health facility. If the form is not provided, simulate completion and advise the judge.

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: Escalating to deadly force/suicide by cop, provoking the subject, rushing the interaction, failing to use de-escalation techniques, using less-lethal devices.

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Chapter 14

TRAFFIC COLLISION INVESTIGATION

INTRODUCTION:

Traffic collision scenarios evaluate cadets' ability to manage a crash scene, provide medical aid, direct traffic, investigate the collision, identify all parties, and complete the Texas Peace Officer's Crash Report (CR-3).

KEY PROCEDURES:

Assess injuries and request EMS. Establish traffic control using cones, flares, and/or manual direction — all cadets should wear reflective safety vests. Separate and interview all parties and witnesses. Complete the CR-3 form accurately and legibly (most points come from the form). Draw a field diagram with north arrow. Texas is a no-fault state — officers document what occurred based on statements and evidence, not determine fault.

SCORING TIP: *The CR-3 form is where most points are earned or lost. Practice filling it out. Ensure the field diagram is neat, accurate, and includes a directional arrow. Legible handwriting is essential.*

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: *Incomplete CR-3, missing diagram north arrow, failing to request EMS, poor traffic control, not wearing reflective vest.*

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Chapter 15

TRAFFIC STOPS — FELONY

(High Risk)

INTRODUCTION:

Felony (high-risk) traffic stops require maximum control through distance, cover, and coordinated verbal commands. This scenario starts with vehicles already positioned.

POSITIONS:

Unit #1: P1 (driver) operates PA system and gives commands. P2 (passenger) is arresting officer and radio operator.

Unit #2: B3 (driver) assists with arrests. B4 (passenger) provides tactical cover and assists with vehicle clearing.

COMMAND SEQUENCE:

Via PA: (1) Identify agency and reason for stop. (2) 'ALL OCCUPANTS — HANDS ON TOP OF YOUR HEAD.' (3) Remove driver first: turn off vehicle, drop keys, open door, exit facing away, lift shirt to show waistband, turn 360°, walk backward using directed steps ('TAKE THREE STEPS BACK'). Never say 'walk to the sound of my voice.' (4) P2 takes over voice commands to position suspect for B3 to handcuff. (5) Repeat for each occupant. (6) Final call: 'ANYONE REMAINING IN THE VEHICLE — COME OUT NOW.' (7) P1 and B4 approach and clear vehicle tactically, including trunk.

SCORING TIP: Use directed steps ('take three steps back, stop') rather than vague commands. Illuminate the scene with all available lights including spotlights, even in daytime.

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: Crossfire, lasering teammates, failing to clear trunk, not confirming stolen vehicle before stop, poor command presence.

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Unauthorized Use of Vehicle (TX PC §31.07)
- Evading Arrest (TX PC §38.04)
- Aggravated Robbery (TX PC §29.03)

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Chapter 16

TRAFFIC STOPS — MISDEMEANOR

INTRODUCTION:

Basic traffic stops are evaluated on the 7-step violator contact method, officer safety, radio procedures, citation completion, and overall professionalism.

7-STEP VIOLATOR CONTACT:

1. Greeting/identify yourself and agency. 2. Identify driver and assess condition. 3. State the violation. 4. State action to be taken. 5. Take action (write citation). 6. Explain what violator must do (court date/contact info). 7. Professional departure.

APPROACH:

Check mirrors before exiting. Close door quietly. Approach on the traffic side, staying out of traffic lanes. Place handprint on trunk/tailgate. Observe occupants for furtive movements. Position in bladed stance behind driver's door (gun side away). P2 covers from passenger side.

VIOLATOR CONTACT:

Use 'YOU' language: 'You were observed exceeding the posted speed limit' (correct) vs. 'I saw you speeding' (incorrect). Never accept ID inside a wallet — have them remove it. Request DL and proof of insurance. Check registration and inspection stickers. Check VIN against insurance card.

RADIO PROCEDURES:

Run all subjects via NCIC/TCIC: last name, first name, middle name, suffix, sex, race, DOB. Spell names using phonetic alphabet. Request DL history and status. Verify vehicle registration. If warrants hit — CONFIRM before arrest. Passengers are NOT required to provide ID unless probable cause exists for a crime (Failure to Identify PC §38.02 does NOT apply to passengers).

CITATION:

Fill out ALL blanks with legible handwriting. If information is unknown, write 'N/A' — but only after asking the violator. Get violator's signature: 'This is not a plea of guilt, but a promise to appear in court.' Never quote the cost of a citation. Direct violator to contact the court for cost information. End professionally: 'Drive safe' or 'Thank you for your cooperation.'

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: Turning back to violator, accepting ID in wallet, quoting citation cost, not running plates/subjects, failing to confirm warrants before arrest, timid/unprofessional demeanor.

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Chapter 17

UNKNOWN CALL FOR SERVICE

OVERVIEW:

Unknown calls test cadets' adaptability. The scenario develops in real-time and may involve any combination of other scenario types. Key skills: proper approach, situational awareness, contact/cover, verbal communication, investigation, and officer safety. Confirm address and request call history. Approach cautiously. Be prepared for anything.

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Terroristic Threat (TX PC §22.07)
- Criminal Mischief (TX PC §28.03)
- Theft (TX PC §31.03)

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Chapter 18

WHITE COLLAR CRIME

OVERVIEW:

Cadets act as detectives executing a search warrant raid for stolen property. Emphasis on intelligence gathering, tactical entry, systematic evidence collection, and proper documentation. Interview an intelligence officer thoroughly — they only answer questions asked. Verify warrant details (address, description, items to seize, judge signature/date). Search only in areas where listed items could reasonably be found. Collect documents using gloves/tweezers. Leave warrant copy at premises.

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Chapter 19 HOMICIDE INVESTIGATION

(Interview & Interrogation)

OVERVIEW:

Cadets act as homicide detectives investigating a recent killing. Interview witnesses, develop suspects through evidence analysis, conduct interrogation using proper Miranda procedures, attempt to obtain a voluntary written confession, and prepare a search or arrest warrant with sworn affidavit establishing probable cause. Key skills: reading body language, asking good questions, building rapport, using lawful deception techniques. Never use physical intimidation — points deducted for mistreatment.

TYPICAL RELATED CRIMINAL OFFENSES:

- Murder (TX PC §19.02)
- Capital Murder (TX PC §19.03)
- Manslaughter (TX PC §19.04)

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Chapter 20 DISASTER RESPONSE

(Incident Command System)

OVERVIEW:

Cadets manage a simulated disaster using NIMS/ICS principles. No field work — this is a command-and-control exercise. Establish Unified Command structure with Command, Operations, Planning, Logistics, and Finance/Administration sections. Develop an Incident Action Plan. Make critical decisions under pressure. Coordinate multi-agency response.

ICS STRUCTURE:

Incident Commander → PIO, Safety Officer, Liaison Officer → Operations Section (field response), Planning Section (situation/resources/documentation), Logistics Section (supplies/communications/medical/food), Finance/Administration Section (costs/time/procurement). Complete FEMA ICS-100 training for foundational knowledge.

SCORING TIP: *Demonstrate clear delegation of the five ICS functions across your team. Use proper ICS terminology. Create a visible organizational chart. Judges want to see structured decision-making, not chaos.*

COMMON DEDUCTIONS: *Giving up, endangering simulated lives, yelling/screaming at team members, failure to establish command structure.*

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EVENTS

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Chapter 21

BICYCLE OBSTACLE COURSE

Timed navigation of a law enforcement bicycle obstacle course. Elements may include: 25-yard ride, braking box, serpentine through 10 cones, curb lofting, 10-second track stand, figure eights, circles within decreasing squares (12x12, 10x10, 8x8), tactical dismount, and 25-yard bike carry. Touching/knocking cones adds time penalties. Bicycles and helmets provided. Top 3 fastest times win awards.

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Chapter 22

NON-EMERGENCY VEHICLE COURSE (NEVO)

Cadets must be 16+ with valid DL and advisor approval. Negotiate a course with stops, turns, backing, and parallel parking. Penalties for missing turn signals or hitting cones. One timed run only. Smooth braking/acceleration and efficient driving earn best scores.

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Chapter 23

PHYSICAL AGILITY COURSE

Individual timed course with obstacles: high jump, balance beams, cones, tires, dummy drag, 20 push-ups, 20 sit-ups, 50-meter sprint. May include airsoft shooting, door breaching, and suspect handcuffing. Separate awards for male/female cadet and advisor categories.

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Chapter 24

SHOOT/DON'T SHOOT SIMULATOR

Firearms simulation using infrared laser weapons projected onto screen scenarios. Cadets interact with scenarios using verbal commands, weapon presentation, and shoot/don't-shoot judgment. Scored on gun handling, reaction time, verbalization, accuracy, and judgment. Top 3 scores win awards.

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Chapter 25

FIREARMS SHOOTING COMPETITION

Requires 5+ hours certified instruction and 100+ rounds supervised live fire before competition. Minimum age 18. Pistol and rifle courses fired on NRA B-8 targets at 25 yards. Course of fire: Slow (5 shots/60 sec), Timed (5 shots/20 sec), Rapid (5 shots/10 sec), each repeated 5 times = 75 rounds total. Firearms and ammo provided. NRA rules govern.

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Chapter 26

CLIMBING/RAPPELLING TOWER

Safety-briefed climbing and rappelling experience. Required: closed-toe shoes, long hair secured under helmet. Not a scored/awarded event — for skill development and participation.

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Chapter 27

CHALLENGE GAMES

Game-show-style challenges testing law enforcement knowledge through formats like Jeopardy, Minute to Win It, and Who Wants to Be a Millionaire. 45-minute sessions, offered hourly. Not an awarded event.

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Chapter 28

LAW ENFORCEMENT KNOWLEDGE EXAM

Sample written examination on Texas laws and codes. 45-minute maximum. Offered hourly, walk-in format. Not awarded — practical experience exercise only.

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Chapter 29

TUG-OF-WAR CHALLENGE

Post vs. Post competition: 1v1, 2v2, 3v3, 4v4. One minute per pull. Gloves recommended. No cleats. Top post per division receives award.

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Chapter 30

SWAT CALL (HIGH RISK)

Uses Simunition (non-lethal marking rounds) in converted real firearms. Full protective gear required. Teams plan and execute a tactical assault on a hostage/barricaded person scenario. 5 minutes planning, 5 minutes execution, 15 minutes total. Scored on approach, communication, entry, accuracy, safety, hostage rescue, and suspect arrest. Top team receives the 'Best Texas Cadet SWAT Team' trophy cup.

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200 N. Greenville Ave, Richardson, TX 75081
(972) 744-4801 | rpdcadets.com

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